MAP SKILLS & ATLASES

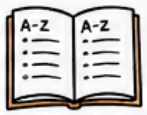


SwotSpot ZA

1 Atlas Index

1 Purpose

- Alphabetical list (A-Z) at the back of the atlas to find places quickly.



2 The 4 Key Details

- Page number (where to turn)



- Grid reference (e.g., B3)



- Coordinates (Latitude & Longitude)

40° N , 75° W



3 Quick Memory Key

P - G - C

(Page → Grid → Coordinates)

2 Map Symbols & Key

1 Legend / Key

- Explains what symbols mean so the map isn't cluttered.

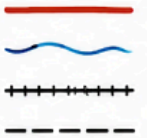


2 3 Symbol Types

- **Point Symbols:** Dots/Icons for single places (e.g., city dot, hospital cross, airport plane).



- **Line Symbols:** Lines for features that connect (e.g., roads, rivers, railway tracks, borders).



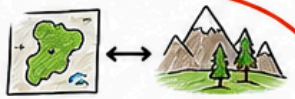
- **Area Symbols:** Colors/Shading for large areas (e.g., green for forests, blue for oceans, brown for mountains).



3 Map Scales

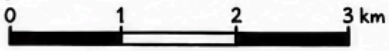
1 Definition

- Map Distance vs. Real Ground Distance.



2 3 Types of Scales

- **Word Scale:** Plain text (e.g., "1 cm represents 1 km").
- **Line Scale:** A mini-ruler on the map showing real ground distance.



- **Ratio Scale (RF):** Same units (e.g., 1 : 50 000).

3 Quick Conversion Trick



1 cm = 500 m

(Knock off 2 zeros from 50 000 cm to get meters)

4 Alpha-Numeric Grids

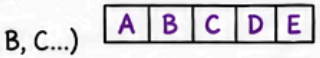
1 Purpose

- Divides local maps into grid blocks using rows and columns.



2 Structure

- Columns (Top/Bottom): Labeled with Letters (A, B, C...)



- Rows (Sides): Labeled with Numbers (1, 2, 3...)



3 Rule to Remember

Letter FIRST, Number SECOND

(e.g., C 4)